

LEDGER · 2026-08-28 · AGRICULTURAL BIOTECHNOLOGY

Brassicaceae-Compatible Endophytic Inoculants via Axenic Submerged Fermentation of *Serendipita indica*

REJECTED

This concept did **not** clear the framework.
The reasoning is published in full below.
What the assessment found

Incumbent benchmark	Penicillium bilaiae (JumpStart by Novonesis)
Entry application	B2B liquid seed treatment for bulk canola seed
Measured advantage	Canola yield increase of +6.5% to +6.7% vs incumbent's +5.0% to +8.0% (~1.0x / parity); seed oil content increase of +0.9% absolute.
Time to first revenue	24 months
Regulatory risk	Low — no material regulatory CapEx reported (\$0 estimated)

Why it failed

- Voided by: Capital and time to revenue, Economics undisclosed, Negative control / sub-2x, Form-factor / handling regression

Assessment

The venture fails multiple gates: it explicitly lacks market absence (already commercialized as AGTIV IGNITE), exceeds startup CapEx limits at \$415,500, takes 24 months to reach first revenue, and offers no 2x yield performance multiplier over *Penicillium bilaiae*. Furthermore, the liquid suspension introduces a handling regression against dry/granular incumbent formulations.

Also flagged

- no_equipment_list
- no_opex

A rejection is not a claim that the science is wrong. It means the venture case did not survive: the comparator was not what the buyer actually buys, the comparison was not like-for-like, the advantage fell short of a step change, or the capital and time to first revenue were prohibitive.

Assessed 2026-08-28 against seven gates plus the voiding sub-tests. [How the method works](#) · [Browse all concepts](#)

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Method

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